

Margin

HOW IT WORKS

Everything that arrives, in one place

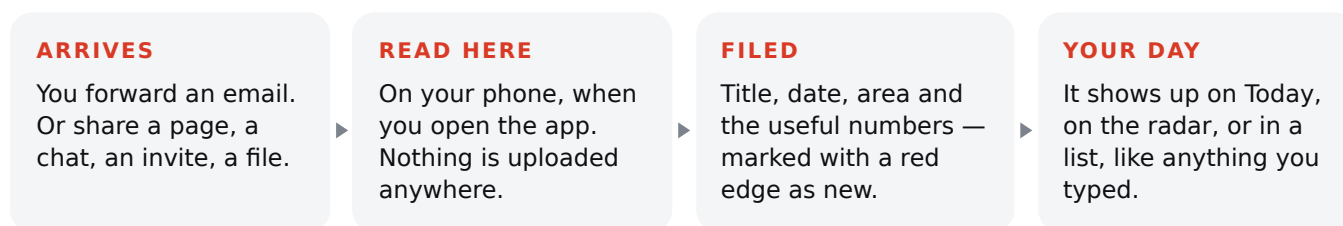
Most of what you have to do arrives somewhere else first — an email, an invite, a message, a bill. Margin gives all of that one address to arrive at, reads it on your phone, and files it. You are left with a list, not an inbox.

01 The one thing to set up

Make a new email address that only Margin uses. Not your main one. Forward anything you want handled — a renewal notice, a school letter, a quote, a booking — to that address, and it becomes an item. Nothing else can reach Margin, so nothing else has to be filtered out.

- 1 Create a fresh Gmail address, e.g. `yourname.margin@gmail.com`.
- 2 In Margin: **Sources** → **Add a source** → **Gmail**, paste the client ID from the setup steps shown there.
- 3 Forward, or set up a rule in your main mailbox to forward the senders that always matter.

02 What happens then



You do not approve each one. Things file themselves and wait to be noticed — **Just arrived** at the top of Sources holds anything you have not looked at yet, and *Clear marks* empties it. Prefer to approve first? Settings → Sources → *File new things automatically*: Off.

03 What Margin takes out of a message

IT SEES	YOU GET
A renewal or expiry date <i>"your policy expires on 3 Nov"</i>	A document on the expiry radar, warning you 60, 30 and 7 days out.
A date with a time <i>"confirmed for 22 Sep at 4:30pm"</i>	A fixed item on that day, with a one-tap button to put it in your calendar.
An amount and a bill <i>"invoice · AED 4,500"</i>	A <i>Pay...</i> item, with the amount and reference number kept on it.
A line asking you for something <i>"please confirm by Thursday"</i>	That line as its own item, dated from the words in it.
Mail you sent yourself	A <i>Waiting on</i> entry with a chase date, rather than a job.
A WhatsApp chat <i>exported or pasted</i>	Only the lines that ask something or carry a date. The chatter is dropped.

At most three items from any one message, and the same message is never read twice. Every item remembers who sent it — on a phone, *Open in Gmail* goes back to the thread.

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HOW IT WORKS

Using it, and getting it back out

04 The five screens

Today	Overdue, today, what just arrived.
Sources	New arrivals; paste anything; set up Gmail.
Ahead	The next seven days, and the expiry radar.
Lists	Buy, gifts, waiting on, someday.
Notes	Search everything, including what you finished.

Settings (the cog, top right) holds your day's times, the two routines, backups and the Claude export.

05 Typing, when you want to

When	tmrw tue this weekend 12 oct end of month
Times of day	commute lunch when home after bedtime
Clock	5pm 17:30 — these go to your calendar
Repeats	monthly every tue every 30 days after done
Expiry	expires 12 mar 2027
Lists	buy ... on noon waiting on Sam for someday

06 How you get told

A web app cannot reliably ping you when it is shut. So anything with a clock time, an **!** or an expiry date is **fixed**: Margin gives it a one-tap → *Calendar* button and your phone does the alerting. Everything else is **soft** — it sits in Margin, slots into your day, and moves to the top once it is late.

TWO HABITS, AND IT STAYS TRUE

Two minutes each evening. Clear what arrived, deal with anything overdue, glance at tomorrow.
Ten minutes each week. Stuck items, chases, the week ahead, the radar, the someday pile, a backup.

07 Handing it to Claude

Settings → **Ask Claude about it** → **Download for Claude** saves a readable file: everything open, what you are waiting on, expiry dates with days remaining, and the last 90 days of finished work — with the questions worth asking already at the top. Upload it to Claude and ask.

“What keeps getting pushed, and what should I drop?” · “Which weeks ahead are overloaded?” · “Which areas take most of my attention — does that match what matters?”

08 · WHERE YOUR DATA IS

On your phone, in the browser, under the address you opened Margin from. It is never uploaded. With Gmail connected, your browser asks Google directly, read-only — Margin cannot send, delete or change anything — and the sign-in is held in memory only, so it goes when you close the app.
Back up. The first tap each Sunday saves a file to Downloads; a red card nags you after fourteen days without one. Clearing your browser's site data, or moving Margin to a new address, starts it empty.